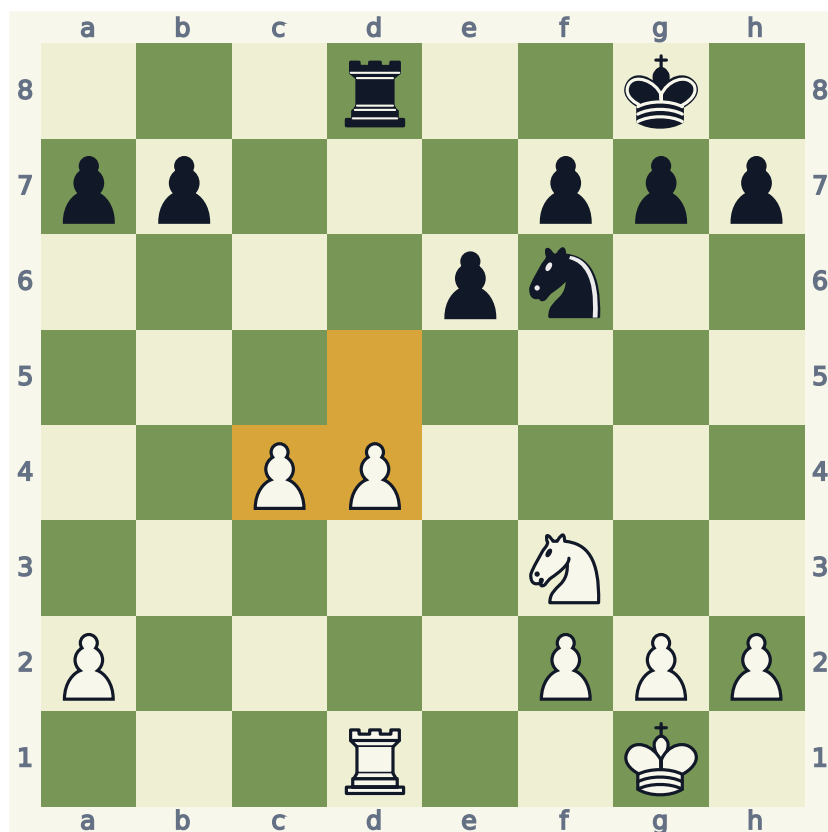


Hanging pawns

A mobile duo can become a fixed target.

Hanging pawns are adjacent pawns, commonly on c4 and d4, without friendly pawns on the neighboring outer files. They can control valuable central squares and advance dynamically. If one is forced forward or exchanged, the remaining pawn may become isolated and easier to blockade.

MODEL A | WHITE TO MOVE



READ THE POSITION

- White's c4/d4 pair controls b5, c5, d5 and e5.
- There are no white b- or e-pawns to support the duo.
- d5 forces a structural decision and can leave an isolated pawn.

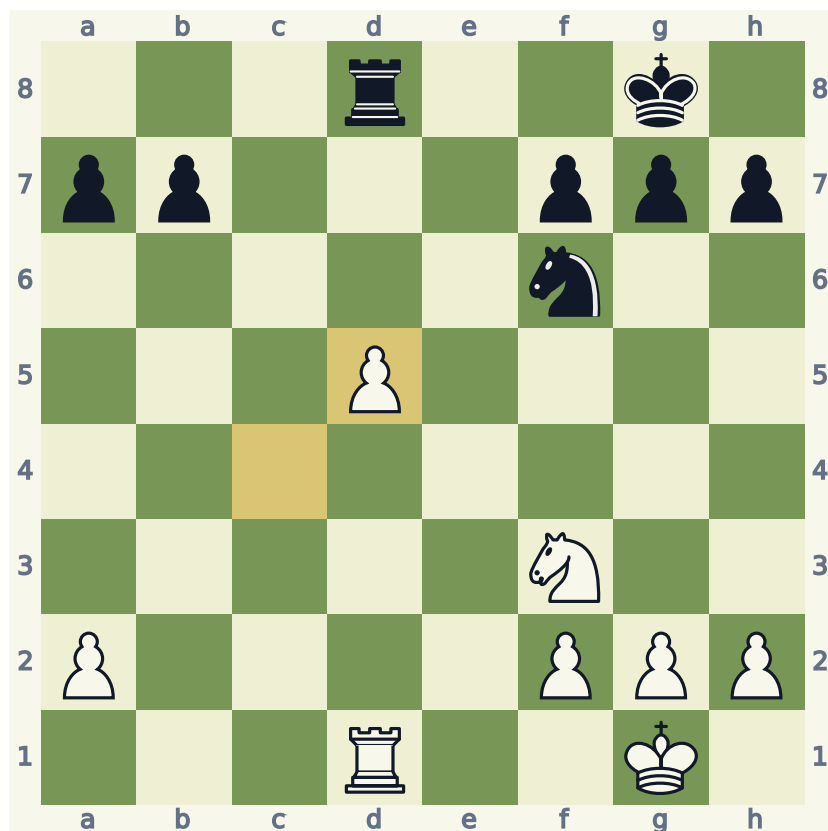
REMEMBER

- Value the duo's mobility and central control.
- Name the square each advance leaves behind.
- Prepare the transformation before committing.

Follow the logic

1. d5 exd5 2. cxd5

MODEL A | POSITION AFTER THE LINE



d5

Use the duo's mobility. The advance may gain space or open lines, but it gives up the side-by-side formation.

...exd5

Black exchanges its e-pawn for the advanced pawn. White must already know which pawn or piece will recapture.

cx d5

White now has one isolated pawn on d5. Rd1 supports it, but Black's rook attacks it. The old hanging-pawn plan has become an isolated-pawn plan.

THE OPPONENT'S PLAN

Black often pressures both pawns and tries to provoke an unfavorable advance. White should coordinate pieces so that a central push creates threats instead of simply presenting a new target.

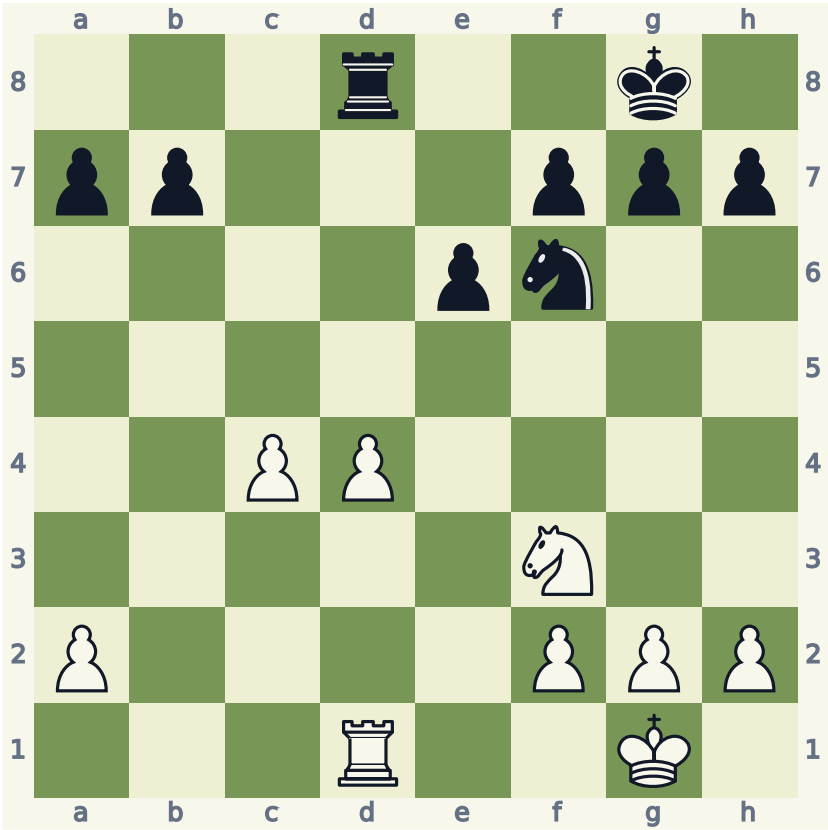
WHEN THE IDEA FAILS

A pawn duo is not weak merely because it lacks neighbors. Its control of central squares can support active pieces. The defender must prevent useful advances before assuming an ending will be favorable.

Find the plan

Set a timer for 6 minutes. Write the reasons, not just a move.

EXERCISE B | WHITE TO MOVE



- 1. Which square becomes available to Black after c5?
- 2. How does ...Nd5 affect the remaining d4-pawn?
- 3. What should White have prepared before choosing c5?

CHANGE ONE FEATURE

If White could exchange Black's blockading knight immediately, would c5 look different?

YOUR PLAN, THE OPPONENT'S REPLY, AND THE RESULTING POSITION

Position code (FEN): 3r2k1/pp3ppp/4pn2/8/2PP4/5N2/P4PPP/3R2K1 w - - 0 1

Answers and transfer

1. The d5-square is no longer controlled by a pawn on c4: White's c-pawn has moved to c5 and now controls b6/d6. Black can use the newly available post.
2. ...Nd5 blockades d4 and is supported by e6. The d4-pawn cannot advance, while c5 and d4 form a chain that may be attacked at its base.
3. White needs a concrete benefit such as a queenside target, a piece route or a way to challenge Nd5. Advancing just to gain space can surrender the most important central square.

ONE ILLUSTRATIVE LEGAL LINE

1. c5 Nd5

Changed feature: Yes. The advance is less committal in practice if the main blockader can be removed favorably. You must still evaluate the resulting pawn structure and any new enemy entry square.

APPLY IT TO YOUR GAMES

Compare c5, d5 and a waiting move in the exercise. For each, draw the new pawn attacks and identify Black's best blockading square.

Self-check: Award 0-2 points per numbered answer: 1 for the relevant fact, 1 for its consequence. Add 2 for the changed-feature answer. Revisit the lesson at 5/8 or below; repeat from memory tomorrow and one week later.

Related topics: 06, 15, 19. | Reference links and notation key: 00_Start_Here.pdf.